



Siri's new trainer!

Apple acquired a UK based speech technology start-up VocalIQ to improve Siri. <http://dgit.in/Nv15ao>



DIY Games for iOS!

If you have an idea and you want to build your game for iOS then here's a quick tutorial. <http://dgit.in/Nv15ap>

Digit Squad

facebook.com/tools/explorer, which is specifically built for Facebook's API and is quite user friendly with its extensive documentation. However, there would be one thing in common for all APIs. Fields that ask you to choose "method type" generally show you two options, 'Get' and 'Post' methods.

As suggested by its name, the 'Get' method is used when you simply want to retrieve any information using the API; E.g. Using Facebook's API to retrieve the status updates made by user 'x' or his personal messages, which he should have given you permission to access. On the other hand, the 'Post' method is used to update any data; E.g. Using Facebook's API to update the latest status or to send a private message to another user 'y' from profile of user 'x', for which user 'x' has given the required permission.

Sending your first API request with GET

Now that you're familiar with request types, let's get started with sending your first HTTP request.

1. Open up 'Graph API Explorer', which is available at <https://developers.facebook.com/tools/explorer> (or any other similar service). Let's suppose you want to check your recent status updates (you can check someone else's too, but you'd require their access token and that button "Sign up with Facebook" is a way to obtain it). Since we only want to retrieve some information, we'll use the 'GET' method.
2. Most APIs need authentication (to reduce misuse of information) and similarly Facebook requires an Access Token. It can be obtained by clicking on Get Token > Get Access Token > Choose relevant data permissions (For now, choose "user_posts", "user_status" and "publish_actions" under User Data Permissions and Extended Permissions)
3. A pop-up will appear asking for your permission to allow it to view your details.
4. Click on 'OK'.
5. Your access token is now updated. You'll use this token for your own account, hence treat it like your password in cryptic form and don't share it publicly.
6. Now, in the below field, choose 'Get' method and the latest API i.e. v2.5.
7. In the text field, put "me" and click "Submit".
8. You just made your first API request! The result will show your name and user ID. Now copy that user ID and paste it in the same text field.
9. Add "/feed" at the end. It should look something like "708603782516433/feed".
10. Click on "Submit" and voila! All your status updates will appear.

Wasn't that pretty easy? Now, try doing that using a simple URL (and yeah, it's possible!). In URL form, it would look something like: https://graph.facebook.com/708603782516433/feed?access_token=your_access_token Notice how it has borrowed most of the content from the Graph API Explorer itself.

Sending a request with POST

Now, let's use the POST method by updating your status utilising Facebook's API.

1. Let's return to the Graph API Explorer and choose "POST" method this time.
2. In the text area, at the end of "708603782516433/feed" just add "?message=customise_this_line" and hit the "Submit" button.
3. A cryptic 'id' will be returned, which is actually the ID of your status update.
4. Check your timeline and sure enough you'll see that your status has been updated!

Alternatively, you can use a plug-in called 'Postman' for Chrome to experiment with POST requests.

Putting APIs to work

So that's basically how POST and GET methods work. Next you'll want to put their functionality to work in your web applications. This could be daunting at first, since almost all API services differ in their way of implementation. However, an API's access token and a basic library provided by the website are usually common. Unless you want to mug up Computer Science, it's better to read the documentation of each API separately and understand how they get the work done. Armed with this basic knowledge, you can now get started and implement it on your own websites. As an assignment, head over to <https://developers.facebook.com/> and implement your own "Sign up with Facebook" button on your website to get users signed up. Happy coding.



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Tablet, Mobile

सुरक्षा



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98.22.88.25.62

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